



Social Science Part 2 — Cbse Chapter Test — 20 Marks

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: Social Science Part 2 | Class: Class 8

Total Marks: 20 | Time Allowed: 0h 40m | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. Read all questions carefully before answering.
2. All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.
3. Marks for each question are indicated on the right.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A Attempt all 8 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
1	Why did Dr. B.R. Ambedkar describe the right to constitutional remedies as the 'very soul of the Constitution'? (A) Because it grants the right to vote to all adult citizens (B) Because it ensures free education for all children aged 6 to 14 (C) Because it abolishes untouchability and all forms of discrimination (D) Because it allows citizens to approach the Supreme Court if their fundamental rights are violated Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. The right to constitutional remedies allows citizens to approach the Supreme Court if their fundamental rights are violated, ensuring that these rights are not just promises on paper but can actually be protected and enforced. Dr. Ambedkar called it the very soul and heart of the Constitution. [Ch 5: Citizenship: Rights and Duties]	1
2	Based on the median age data provided, which country has the highest median age among those listed? (A) Japan (B) India (C) China (D) Italy Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Japan has the highest median age at 50 years, compared to Italy (48), Germany (47), China (40), USA (39), and India (28). This reflects Japan's ageing population. [Ch 6: Dynamics of Population]	1



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3	In Akbar's atelier, how was the process of creating Mughal miniature paintings typically carried out through collaboration? (A) One artist would draw the lines, another fill the colours, and a third add finishing touches (B) Each artist independently completed an entire painting from start to finish (C) Artists competed against each other, and only the best painting was selected (D) Artists were divided by region, with each region specialising in one colour palette Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. In Akbar's atelier, collaborations among artists were common — one artist would draw the lines, another fill the colours, and a third add finishing touches, reflecting the collective nature of Mughal court painting production. [Ch 8: Cultural Currents: 13th to 17th Centuries]	1
4	Discrimination is defined as mistreating a person or group based on which of the following? (A) Only caste and religion (B) Only gender and economic background (C) Caste, religion, ethnicity, disability, race, physical appearance, gender, sexuality, or economic background (D) Only language and culture Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Discrimination is mistreating any person or group because of their caste, religion, ethnicity, disability, race, physical appearance, gender, sexuality, or economic background. [Ch 5: Citizenship: Rights and Duties]	1
5	Which Article of the Constitution states that the law declared by the Supreme Court is binding on all courts within the territory of India? (A) Article 142 (B) Article 141 (C) Article 143 (D) Article 144 Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Article 141 states that the law declared by the Supreme Court of India is binding on all courts within the territory of India. [Ch 4: The Role of the Judiciary in Our Society]	1



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6	At the early stage of stupa architecture, how was the Buddha represented in the panels and decorative elements? (A) In human form as a seated monk (B) Symbolically through objects such as footprints, the wheel of dharma, or the stupa itself (C) As a crowned king with royal insignia (D) Through inscriptions of his teachings on stone slabs Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. At this early stage, the Buddha was represented symbolically—through objects such as footprints, the wheel of dharma, or the stupa itself—rather than in human form. <i>[Ch 3: A Journey Through Indian Architecture]</i>	1
7	Which Article of the Constitution provides for the establishment of the Supreme Court of India? (A) Article 21 (B) Article 124 (C) Article 32 (D) Article 136 Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Article 124 of the Constitution provides for the establishment of the Supreme Court of India, which is seated in New Delhi. <i>[Ch 4: The Role of the Judiciary in Our Society]</i>	1
8	The Mysuru Palace is an example of which architectural style? (A) Indo-Islamic architecture (B) Indo-Saracenic architecture (C) Gothic architecture (D) Persian architecture Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Indo-Saracenic architecture — The Mysuru Palace, also known as Amba Vilas Palace, is described as a magnificent example of Indo-Saracenic architecture. <i>[Ch 3: A Journey Through Indian Architecture]</i>	1
Section B Attempt all 3 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
9	How did the meaning of 'adhikāra' in ancient texts differ from the modern concept of rights?	2



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	Answer: In ancient texts, adhikāra referred to capacity, competence, or authority — if you were competent to perform a task, that gave you the right to do so. Rights were not guaranteed universally as they are now, since they depended on one's capacity. One exception was that dharma implicitly gave everyone the right to justice. ► Why? The source explains the ancient versus modern understanding of adhikāra and the exception related to dharma. [Ch 5: Citizenship: Rights and Duties]	
10	Why is the Mariana Trench considered one of the harshest environments on Earth, and how do organisms there survive without photosynthesis? Answer: The Mariana Trench has near-freezing temperatures, high pressure, and complete darkness, with its deepest section, the Challenger Deep, reaching over 11,000 metres below sea level. Since there is no light, organisms use energy from chemicals in the water to produce food instead of photosynthesis. ► Why? This question requires synthesizing information about the extreme physical conditions of the trench and the unique biological adaptation of chemosynthesis that allows life to survive there. [Ch 1: World Geography: Some Glimpses]	2
11	How did the water system in the Agra Fort function as an eco-friendly cooling mechanism? Answer: Water from the Yamuna was lifted using Persian wheels into overhead tanks on the walls of the fort. From the tanks, water flowing down through terracotta pipes created fountains, which worked as eco-friendly 'air-conditioners', helping to keep the area cool. ► Why? This tests the student's understanding of an integrated engineering and architectural solution for climate control described in the source. [Ch 3: A Journey Through Indian Architecture]	2
Section C Attempt 2 out of 3.		
12	Explain the philosophical concept of the temple as Puruṣha and how temple worship mirrors a spiritual journey. Answer: Temple architecture is based on philosophical concepts where a temple is planned as a representation of the human body—that of Puruṣha or the cosmic being. Vertically, from the top of the śikhara or vimāna (corresponding to the head) down to the platform (corresponding to the feet), the temple symbolises our own being and also the cosmos. Temple worship can be understood as a journey from the outer world, left behind once one crosses the entrance, to the inner world awaiting the worshipper in the garbhagriha, thus mirroring our own spiritual journey from the external to the internal.	3



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	► Why? This question tests understanding of the deeper philosophical symbolism behind temple design and its connection to spiritual practice. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Explain the temple as a representation of Puruṣha or the cosmic being, both horizontally and vertically. - Step 2: Describe the vertical equivalence from śikhara/vimāna (head) to the platform (feet). - Step 3: Connect temple worship as a journey from outer world to garbhagriha, mirroring our spiritual journey. [Ch 3: A Journey Through Indian Architecture]	
	OR Explain how the introduction of wolves in Yellowstone National Park in 1995 led to ecological restoration. Answer: The Yellowstone National Park, located in the Rockies, is an example of ecosystem restoration. The park was experiencing an ecological imbalance due to overgrazing by elk, a type of deer. In 1995, wolves were introduced into the park. As a predator, the wolves hunted the elk, reducing their population. This reduction in elk numbers enabled the return of the flora, which had been overgrazed. The recovery of plant life led to the restoration of ecological balance in the park. This demonstrates how reintroducing a key predator can have cascading positive effects throughout an ecosystem, a process that highlights the interconnectedness of species within a habitat. ► Why? The answer traces the cause-and-effect chain from elk overgrazing to wolf introduction to flora recovery and ecological balance, as described in the source. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Identify the problem — ecological imbalance caused by elk overgrazing. - Step 2: Explain the 1995 wolf introduction and their role as predators reducing elk population. - Step 3: Describe the cascading effect — flora recovery leading to restored ecological balance. [Ch 1: World Geography: Some Glimpses]	
13	How did Delhi evolve as a centre of culture, trade, and administration from the Iron Age to the post-Independence period? Answer: Delhi has thrived as a centre of culture, trade, and administration from the Iron Age. The Rajputs, Turks, and Mughals built forts, roads, and markets, while the British built a new capital for their Indian empire and introduced railways and electricity. After Independence, New Delhi became the capital of the Indian Republic with many ministries, industries, universities, and research centres, attracting people for jobs and education from across the country. As population expanded, the National Capital Region (NCR) was created to include NOIDA and Ghaziabad, easing pressure on infrastructure. Since the 1990s, Gurugram became a major IT and BPO hub. ► Why? The answer traces Delhi's historical evolution through multiple ruling powers to its modern role as the national capital with expanding urban regions. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Describe Delhi's historical significance from the Iron Age through Mughal and British rule - Step 2: Explain its post-Independence role as capital with ministries and institutions - Step 3: Conclude with NCR creation and Gurugram's emergence as an IT hub	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	[Ch 7: India's Urban Landscape]	

